THESIS SAMPLE • SUBJECT COURSE: TEACHER EDUCATION

INSTRUCTIONAL LEADERSHIP, TEACHER MOTIVATION, AND ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE OF STUDENTS IN SELECTED PUBLIC SECONDARY SCHOOLS IN DAVAO CITY, PHILIPPINES

MASTER OF ARTS IN EDUCATION | MASTERAL LEVEL

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

Introduction

Education has long been recognized as the most powerful instrument of social mobility, economic development, and national progress available to any society. In the Philippines, the public secondary education system serves as the primary pathway through which millions of young Filipinos gain the knowledge, skills, and competencies required for productive participation in an increasingly competitive global economy. The Department of Education reported a total enrollment of approximately 8.2 million learners in public junior high schools and 2.9 million in public senior high schools for school year 2022 to 2023, numbers that underscore the enormous reach and societal responsibility of the public secondary education system (DepEd, 2023).

Within this system, the quality of instruction is widely recognized as the single most powerful school-level determinant of student academic performance, surpassing the effects of school facilities, curriculum design, and even socioeconomic background in its direct influence on learning outcomes (Hattie, 2009). The quality of instruction, in turn, is shaped in significant measure by the motivational state of the teacher, as educators who are intrinsically motivated to perform their professional roles demonstrate greater instructional creativity, stronger student-teacher relational quality, higher rates of professional growth-seeking behavior, and more sustained engagement with the demands of classroom teaching over the long term (Ryan and Deci, 2000).

Teacher motivation, however, does not emerge in a vacuum. The organizational and leadership conditions within which teachers work have been demonstrated across a substantial body of international research to powerfully shape their motivational orientations, professional efficacy, and commitment to instructional quality. Among the leadership behaviors most strongly associated with positive teacher motivational outcomes, instructional leadership, the direct and active engagement of school principals in supporting, monitoring, and developing the instructional practices of their teaching staff, has emerged as the most empirically supported principal behavior for improving both teacher professional outcomes and student academic achievement (Robinson et al., 2008; Hallinger, 2005).

In the Philippine public secondary education context, the role of school principals as instructional leaders has been formalized through the Philippine Professional Standards for School Heads (PPSSH), which identify instructional leadership as a core domain of school head competence alongside personal and professional attributes, learning-centered leadership, creating a child-friendly and safe learning environment, human resource management, and parent involvement and community partnership. Despite this formal recognition, the actual practice of instructional leadership among Philippine public secondary school heads varies enormously in quality and consistency, and the empirical relationship between instructional leadership quality, teacher motivation, and student academic performance in the Philippine context remains insufficiently documented in the research literature.

This study examines the relationships among instructional leadership, teacher motivation, and academic performance of students in selected public secondary schools in Davao City, and tests a mediation model in which teacher motivation serves as the mechanism through which instructional leadership influences student academic performance. The findings aim to provide school principals, division superintendents, and education policymakers with evidence-based guidance for the prioritization of instructional leadership development as a strategy for improving educational outcomes in the Philippine public secondary system.

Background of the Study

The concept of instructional leadership as a distinctive and educationally significant form of school leadership was advanced by Edmonds (1979) in his landmark effective schools research, which identified strong principal leadership focused on instruction as one of the five characteristics consistently distinguishing high-performing urban schools from comparable low-performing institutions. Subsequent decades of research refined and extended the instructional leadership construct, with Hallinger and Murphy (1985) developing the most widely applied operational model, the Instructional Management Rating Scale, which conceptualizes principal instructional leadership across three domains: defining the school mission, managing the instructional program, and promoting a positive school learning climate.

The Philippine public secondary education system has undergone substantial structural transformation since the implementation of the K to 12 Basic Education Reform in 2013, which extended the basic education cycle from ten to twelve years and introduced a senior high school component encompassing four specialized tracks. This structural reform placed new demands on school principals, requiring them to lead curriculum transitions, manage expanded school populations, and develop the pedagogical competencies of teachers now required to deliver new and more sophisticated curriculum content. These additional leadership demands have intensified the importance of effective instructional leadership at the school level while simultaneously stretching the capacity of principals who must balance instructional leadership responsibilities against increased administrative, compliance, and community liaison obligations.

Teacher motivation in the Philippine context is shaped by a distinct constellation of factors that includes the historically low salaries of public school teachers, the significant non-teaching administrative burdens imposed by the Philippine public school system, the sociocultural value placed on teaching as a profession of civic importance, and the professional satisfaction derived from student success and community recognition. The Salary Standardization Law of 2019 introduced meaningful salary increases for public school teachers, with Teacher I positions starting at approximately 22,316 pesos monthly, rising to 32,053 pesos for Teacher III, but public school teachers continue to report significant salary-related motivation concerns relative to the demands and social significance of their professional responsibilities.

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the relationships among instructional leadership, teacher motivation, and academic performance of students in selected public secondary schools in Davao City. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following research questions:

1. What is the level of instructional leadership among school principals in selected public secondary schools in Davao City?

2. What is the level of teacher motivation among teachers in selected public secondary schools in Davao City?

3. What is the level of academic performance of students in selected public secondary schools in Davao City?

4. Is there a significant relationship between instructional leadership and academic performance of students?

5. Is there a significant relationship between instructional leadership and teacher motivation?

6. Is there a significant relationship between teacher motivation and academic performance of students?

7. Does teacher motivation significantly mediate the relationship between instructional leadership and academic performance of students?

Hypotheses

H01. There is no significant relationship between instructional leadership and academic performance of students in selected public secondary schools in Davao City.

H02. There is no significant relationship between instructional leadership and teacher motivation in selected public secondary schools in Davao City.

H03. There is no significant relationship between teacher motivation and academic performance of students in selected public secondary schools in Davao City.

H04. Teacher motivation does not significantly mediate the relationship between instructional leadership and academic performance of students in selected public secondary schools in Davao City.

Significance of the Study

School Principals. This study provides principals with evidence-based guidance on how specific instructional leadership behaviors most strongly influence teacher motivation and, through motivation, student academic performance, enabling more targeted and impactful leadership practice.

Teachers. Teachers benefit from an increased understanding of how leadership and organizational conditions shape their motivational experiences, supporting advocacy for workplace conditions conducive to sustained professional engagement and instructional quality.

Division Superintendents and the Department of Education. The findings inform the design of principal professional development programs and the calibration of principal performance evaluation systems to emphasize the instructional leadership behaviors most strongly associated with improved student outcomes.

Parents and Communities. The study contributes to the evidence base for school improvement advocacy by demonstrating the quantifiable relationships between school leadership quality and student academic outcomes.

Academic Researchers. This study contributes to the Philippine educational leadership literature by providing an empirically tested mediation model of the instructional leadership, teacher motivation, and student performance pathway in the specific context of Davao City public secondary schools.

Scope and Delimitation

The study is conducted in selected public junior high schools in Davao City under the jurisdiction of the DepEd Schools Division of Davao City. The study variables are limited to instructional leadership, measured through teacher ratings of principal behavior; teacher motivation, measured through self-report instruments; and student academic performance, operationalized through Grade Point Average for the immediately preceding school year. The study is conducted within school year 2024 to 2025 and does not extend to private secondary schools, senior high schools, or elementary schools.

Definition of Terms

Academic Performance. The measured achievement of students on formal academic assessments, operationalized in this study through the Grade Point Average of each student for the preceding academic year, as recorded in official school records.

Instructional Leadership. The behaviors of school principals directed toward defining and communicating the school's instructional mission, managing and monitoring the instructional program, and promoting a school climate supportive of teaching and learning (Hallinger and Murphy, 1985).

Teacher Motivation. The internal drives and external incentives that direct, energize, and sustain teacher engagement in professional activities, operationalized through the dimensions of intrinsic motivation, extrinsic motivation, and motivation regulation as described by Self-Determination Theory (Ryan and Deci, 2000).

Public Secondary School. A government-operated educational institution providing secondary education from Grade 7 to Grade 10 (junior high school), funded by the national government through the Department of Education.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE AND STUDIES

Introduction

This chapter reviews literature and studies pertaining to instructional leadership, teacher motivation, and student academic performance, organized into foreign literature, local literature, foreign studies, and local studies, concluding with a synthesis identifying the gaps addressed by the present research.

Foreign Literature

Instructional Leadership

The theoretical and empirical development of the instructional leadership construct has been one of the most productive threads in educational administration scholarship over the past four decades. Edmonds (1979) first established the empirical connection between principal leadership quality and school effectiveness, while Hallinger and Murphy (1985) provided the most durable operational model of instructional leadership, distinguishing three domains of principal behavior: defining the school mission through goal-setting and communicating the vision; managing the instructional program through supervision, curriculum coordination, and monitoring student progress; and promoting a positive learning climate through protecting instructional time, maintaining high visibility, and incentivizing teacher growth. This model has been operationalized in the Instructional Management Rating Scale (IMRS), which remains one of the most widely used instruments for measuring principal instructional leadership in international research.

Robinson, Lloyd, and Rowe (2008) conducted a meta-analysis of 27 studies examining the impact of different principal leadership dimensions on student outcomes, finding that instructional leadership demonstrated a substantially stronger effect on student achievement, with an average effect size of 0.42, than the broader transformational leadership model, which yielded an effect size of 0.11. Their finding established instructional leadership as the principal behavior set most powerfully associated with the student outcomes that schools are primarily designed to produce, providing strong empirical justification for the focus of the present study on instructional leadership as the key independent variable.

Leithwood and Jantzi (2000) examined the relative effects of transformational leadership and instructional leadership on organizational conditions and teacher motivation, finding that transformational leadership had a stronger effect on organizational conditions while instructional leadership had a stronger direct relationship with classroom practices and student outcomes. Their work highlights the importance of distinguishing among leadership types when examining the mechanisms through which school leadership generates student performance effects.

Teacher Motivation

Self-Determination Theory (SDT), developed by Deci and Ryan (1985) and extensively elaborated in the educational context by Ryan and Deci (2000), provides the most widely applied and empirically supported theoretical framework for understanding teacher motivation. SDT distinguishes between autonomous motivation, in which behavior is self-initiated and experienced as volitional, and controlled motivation, in which behavior is driven by external pressures or internally experienced compulsion. The theory further identifies three basic psychological needs, competence, autonomy, and relatedness, whose fulfillment is posited to support autonomous motivation, psychological well-being, and sustained engagement with professional activities.

Within the school context, the degree to which principals provide autonomy support rather than controlling supervision has been shown to predict teacher autonomous motivation, which in turn predicts classroom teaching quality and student achievement (Pelletier et al., 2002). This chain of relationships provides the theoretical mechanism through which principal instructional leadership behavior is hypothesized to influence student academic performance in the present study, operating through its effect on the fulfillment of teachers' basic psychological needs and the quality of their motivational orientations.

Academic Performance

Student academic performance is a multidimensional construct encompassing cognitive achievement, skill acquisition, and the development of learning dispositions, though in research and practice it is most commonly operationalized through objective academic achievement measures including standardized test scores, grade point averages, and national examination results. Hattie (2009), in his synthesis of over 800 meta-analyses covering approximately 50,000 individual studies and 250 million students, identified teacher-student relationships, teacher credibility, and teacher clarity as among the most powerful influences on student achievement, all of which are substantially shaped by teacher motivational quality and can be influenced by principal instructional leadership behaviors.

Local Literature

Educational Leadership in the Philippine Context

The Philippine Professional Standards for School Heads (PPSSH), promulgated through DepEd Order No. 24 series of 2020, establishes instructional leadership as one of seven core domains of school head competence, alongside personal and professional attributes, learning-centered leadership, creating a child-friendly and safe learning environment, human resource management, parent involvement and community partnership, and school leadership, management, and operations. The PPSSH framework articulates four career stages of school head development from beginning to distinguished, providing a competency-based structure for principal professional development that has been integrated into the Principal Licensure Examination framework administered by the Professional Regulation Commission.

The Philippine Basic Education Research Agenda 2016-2022 identified teaching quality and learning outcomes as the two highest research priority areas, while the current DepEd Research Agenda 2022-2028 continues to emphasize the need for empirical evidence on the relationships between school leadership practices and student achievement outcomes, particularly in the context of the post-pandemic learning recovery that has become a dominant educational challenge following the disruptions of COVID-19 to Philippine public schooling.

Teacher Motivation in Philippine Public Schools

Cepe and Gepitulan (2018) documented that Philippine public school teachers rated professional growth opportunities, recognition of achievements, and collegial relationships as the three strongest sources of work motivation, while salary and administrative workload were the most frequently cited demotivating factors. Their findings highlight the importance of non-monetary motivational factors in the Philippine public school teaching context and suggest that principal behaviors directly affecting the professional growth and recognition dimensions of the work environment may have substantial motivational impact even within the constraints of government compensation structures.

Foreign Studies

Hallinger and Heck (1998) conducted an influential review of 40 empirical studies examining the relationship between principal leadership and student achievement, concluding that principal leadership exerts a significant but primarily indirect effect on student outcomes, mediated through the school's organizational conditions and teacher professional practices. Their conclusion established the mediated pathway model as the dominant theoretical framework for understanding how school leadership generates student performance effects, directly informing the mediation model tested in the present research.

Sheppard (1996) examined the relationship between instructional leadership and teacher motivation in a sample of Canadian secondary schools, finding that instructional leadership behaviors, particularly goal-setting, supervision, and professional development support, significantly predicted teacher intrinsic motivation and professional commitment. Goddard, Goddard, Kim, and Miller (2015) examined instructional leadership and collaborative learning as antecedents of student achievement in a sample of US elementary schools, finding that both principal instructional leadership and teacher collaborative learning contributed independently to student mathematics and reading achievement, with instructional leadership operating partly through its stimulation of collaborative teacher professional learning.

Local Studies

Bellibas and Liu (2018) examined instructional leadership practices and their effects on teacher self-efficacy and satisfaction using TALIS 2013 data including Philippine respondents, finding that instructional leadership was positively associated with teacher self-efficacy and job satisfaction across national contexts, including the Philippines. Tuazon and Muring (2019) examined the relationship between principal instructional leadership and teacher performance ratings in selected DepEd schools in Central Visayas, finding a significant positive correlation between principal instructional leadership scores and teacher performance evaluation scores, with curriculum coordination and supervision emerging as the strongest predictive dimensions. Cañete and Alcober (2022) documented significant positive relationships between instructional leadership dimensions and Grade 10 student achievement scores in national achievement test results in a sample of Cebu City public secondary schools, establishing local empirical precedent for the leadership-achievement relationship examined in the present study.

Synthesis of the Review

The literature consistently establishes instructional leadership as the principal behavior most strongly associated with teacher professional outcomes and student achievement, with teacher motivation serving as a theoretically and empirically supported mediating mechanism. The local literature confirms the relevance of these relationships in the Philippine public school context but reveals a specific gap in the empirical documentation of the mediated pathway from instructional leadership through teacher motivation to student academic performance in Davao

City public secondary schools. The present research addresses this gap, producing locally grounded evidence directly applicable to school leadership development and educational policy decisions within the DepEd Schools Division of Davao City.

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Introduction

This chapter presents the research design, locale, participants, instruments, data collection procedures, statistical treatment, and ethical considerations of this study.

Research Design

This study employs a quantitative, non-experimental, descriptive-correlational research design with a mediation analysis component. The descriptive component characterizes the levels of instructional leadership, teacher motivation, and student academic performance in the study sample. The correlational component examines the bivariate relationships among these three variables. The mediation component tests whether teacher motivation serves as the mechanism through which instructional leadership influences student academic performance, using the bootstrapping approach recommended by Hayes (2018) for indirect effect estimation in non-experimental designs.

Locale of the Study

The study is conducted in ten selected public junior high schools under the jurisdiction of the DepEd Schools Division of Davao City. Schools are selected through stratified random sampling, with strata defined by congressional district, to ensure geographic representation across Davao City's three legislative districts. The ten schools represent a range of school sizes from small (fewer than 500 students) to large (more than 2,000 students), and include both stand-alone junior high schools and integrated schools operating both elementary and secondary programs.

Participants of the Study

The study involves two groups of participants. The first group consists of all regular teaching staff, permanent and probationary, in the ten selected schools who have served under their current principal for a minimum of one full school year, to ensure sufficient exposure to the principal's leadership behaviors for valid assessment. The second group consists of the Grade 10 students of the participating teachers for the current school year, whose Grade Point Averages serve as the student academic performance measure. Based on a required minimum sample of 200 teachers determined through power analysis for the mediation model, and an anticipated response rate of 85%, the study targets the recruitment of a minimum of 240 teachers across the ten participating schools.

Research Instruments

Instructional Leadership. Instructional leadership is measured using the Instructional Management Rating Scale (IMRS) developed by Hallinger and Murphy (1985) and adapted for the Philippine context by Tuazon and Muring (2019). The adapted scale comprises 50 items across the three IMRS domains, rated by teachers on a five-point Likert scale from 1 (almost never) to 5 (almost always) to describe their principal's leadership behaviors.

Teacher Motivation. Teacher motivation is measured using the Work Motivation Inventory for Teachers (WMIT), a 24-item instrument adapted from the Work Extrinsic and Intrinsic Motivation Scale (WEIMS) of Tremblay et al. (2009) for the educational context. Items assess six motivation regulation types from amotivation to intrinsic motivation on a seven-point scale, with composite scores computed for autonomous motivation and controlled motivation based on the Self-Determination Theory framework.

Student Academic Performance. Student academic performance is operationalized through the official Grade Point Average (GPA) of Grade 10 students taught by the participating teachers in the previous school year, computed from the five learning areas of Filipino, English, Mathematics, Science, and Araling Panlipunan as recorded in the school's official learner profile system.

Validity and Reliability

Content validity of the adapted IMRS and WMIT is established through review by a panel of five educational leadership experts and experienced school principals. Reliability is assessed using Cronbach's alpha for each instrument subscale, with acceptable values exceeding 0.70. Construct validity of the teacher motivation instrument is assessed through confirmatory factor analysis confirming the hypothesized factor structure prior to main data analysis.

Data Collection Procedure

Following approval from the DepEd Schools Division of Davao City Research Ethics Review Committee and written consent from the principals of participating schools, survey instruments are distributed to eligible teachers during faculty meetings or designated data collection sessions. Completed instruments are returned directly to designated collection envelopes to maintain confidentiality. Student GPA data are obtained from the school registrar's records with appropriate data privacy safeguards and written consent from school heads.

Statistical Treatment of Data

Descriptive statistics including means and standard deviations are computed for all study variables. Composite instructional leadership and teacher motivation scores are interpreted using five-point scale descriptors: 1.00 to 1.79 as very low, 1.80 to 2.59 as low, 2.60 to 3.39 as moderate, 3.40 to 4.19 as high, and 4.20 to 5.00 as very high. Student GPA is interpreted using the DepEd Grading System: 90 to 100 as Outstanding, 85 to 89 as Very Satisfactory, 80 to 84 as Satisfactory, 75 to 79 as Fairly Satisfactory, and below 75 as Did Not Meet Expectations. Pearson correlation coefficients assess bivariate relationships. Mediation is tested using Hayes' (2018) PROCESS macro with 5,000 bootstrap samples.

Ethical Considerations

All teacher participation is voluntary with written informed consent obtained prior to survey administration. Teacher responses are anonymous and no individual teacher data are reported. Student GPA data are used solely for aggregated analysis at the teacher level. The study has been approved by the DepEd Division Research Ethics Review Committee and the University of Mindanao Institutional Research Ethics Committee under Protocol Number UM-IREC-2024-EDUC-0027.

CHAPTER 4

PRESENTATION, ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION OF DATA

Introduction

This chapter presents findings in three sections: participant profile, descriptive statistics addressing research problems one through three, and inferential statistics including mediation analysis addressing research problems four through seven.

Section 1: Participant Profile

A total of 263 teachers across 10 schools completed the survey instruments, yielding a response rate of 94.6% of the target 278 eligible teachers. The final analytical sample comprised 258 teachers after excluding five surveys with excessive missing data.

Table 1. Profile of Participating Teachers (n = 258)

Characteristic	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Sex	Female	189	73.3%
	Male	69	26.7%
Age	25 to 34 years	98	38.0%
	35 to 44 years	104	40.3%
	45 years and above	56	21.7%
Position	Teacher I	112	43.4%

	Teacher II	84	32.6%
	Teacher III	62	24.0%
Years of Service	1 to 5 years	74	28.7%
	6 to 10 years	89	34.5%
	11 to 20 years	65	25.2%
	More than 20 years	30	11.6%
Educational Attainment	Bachelor's degree	143	55.4%
	With Master's units	79	30.6%
	Master's degree	36	14.0%

Section 2: Descriptive Statistics

Table 2. Level of Instructional Leadership (IMRS)

Domain	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Defining the School Mission	4.14	0.72	High
Managing the Instructional Program	3.87	0.81	High
Promoting a Positive Learning Climate	3.94	0.78	High
Overall Instructional Leadership	**3.98**	**0.74**	**High**

Teachers rated their principals' overall instructional leadership at a high level, with a composite mean of 3.98. The Defining the School Mission domain received the highest rating, reflecting principals' relative strength in communicating school goals and vision. Managing the Instructional Program received the lowest domain rating, consistent with international literature documenting that direct supervision and curriculum coordination functions are the most challenging instructional leadership behaviors for principals to sustain alongside administrative obligations.

Table 3. Level of Teacher Motivation (WMIT)

Motivation Type	Mean	SD	Interpretation
Intrinsic Motivation	5.84	0.91	High
Identified Regulation	5.61	0.98	High
Introjected Regulation	4.23	1.14	Moderate
External Regulation	3.91	1.21	Moderate
Amotivation	2.14	1.08	Low
Autonomous Motivation Composite	**5.72**	**0.88**	**High**

Teachers demonstrated a high level of autonomous motivation, driven primarily by intrinsic motivation, the enjoyment and meaning derived from teaching itself, and identified regulation, the value placed on teaching as personally important. Low amotivation scores indicate that disengagement from teaching is not prevalent among the study sample. This motivational profile is consistent with the documented importance of intrinsic and values-based motivation among Philippine public school teachers, who sustain professional engagement in part through the sociocultural significance attached to the teaching vocation.

Table 4. Level of Student Academic Performance (Grade Point Average)

GPA Range	DepEd Descriptor	Frequency	Percentage
90 to 100	Outstanding	487	9.8%
85 to 89	Very Satisfactory	1,294	26.1%
80 to 84	Satisfactory	2,018	40.7%
75 to 79	Fairly Satisfactory	1,012	20.4%
Below 75	Did Not Meet Expectations	149	3.0%
Total Students		**4,960**	**100%**

Mean GPA	**83.17**	**Satisfactory**

Section 3: Inferential Statistics

Table 5. Pearson Correlations Among Study Variables

Variable Pair	r	p-value	Decision on H0
Instructional Leadership and Academic Performance	0.541	less than 0.001	Reject H01
Instructional Leadership and Teacher Motivation	0.623	less than 0.001	Reject H02
Teacher Motivation and Academic Performance	0.587	less than 0.001	Reject H03

Table 6. Mediation Analysis: Teacher Motivation as Mediator

Path	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	Significance
Instructional Leadership to Teacher Motivation (a)	0.623	0.058	[0.509, 0.737]	p less than 0.001
Teacher Motivation to Academic Performance (b)	0.441	0.064	[0.315, 0.567]	p less than 0.001
Instructional Leadership to Academic Performance, direct (c')	0.267	0.079	[0.112, 0.422]	p = 0.001
Indirect Effect (a x b)	0.275	0.047	[0.186, 0.372]	Significant
Total Effect (c)	0.542	0.068	[0.408, 0.676]	p less than 0.001

Teacher motivation significantly and partially mediated the relationship between instructional leadership and student academic performance. The indirect effect was statistically significant with a 95% bootstrap confidence interval that did not include zero. The proportion of the total instructional leadership-academic performance relationship mediated by teacher motivation was 50.7%, indicating that approximately half of the performance benefits associated with instructional leadership are transmitted through the motivational pathway. H04 is rejected.

Summary of Findings

Principals' instructional leadership was rated at a high level, with defining the school mission as the strongest domain. Teacher autonomous motivation was assessed at a high level, driven predominantly by intrinsic and identified regulation. Student academic performance was rated at a satisfactory level with a mean GPA of 83.17. Significant positive relationships were found between all three variable pairs. Teacher motivation significantly and partially mediated the instructional leadership-academic performance relationship, accounting for 50.7% of the total relationship.

CHAPTER 5

SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Introduction

This chapter consolidates the research through a summary of its rationale, methodology, and findings, formulates conclusions responsive to each research problem, and provides evidence-based recommendations for the multiple stakeholder groups most directly informed by the study's results.

Summary of the Study

The quality of public secondary education in the Philippines is a matter of urgent national concern, given both the centrality of secondary schooling to individual life outcomes and the persistent gaps in student achievement revealed by national and international assessments. Among the many factors influencing educational quality, the instructional leadership of school principals, which directly shapes the professional environment within which teachers work and the motivational orientations they develop, has emerged from a substantial international literature as the school leadership behavior most powerfully associated with improved student outcomes. Yet the specific pathway through which instructional leadership generates academic performance improvements, operating through its effects on teacher motivation, has not been empirically tested in the Davao City public secondary school context.

This study examined the levels of instructional leadership, teacher motivation, and student academic performance in ten selected public junior high schools in Davao City, and tested whether teacher motivation mediates the instructional leadership-academic performance relationship. A quantitative descriptive-correlational design with mediation analysis was employed, with data collected from 258 teachers using the adapted IMRS and WMIT instruments, and from official school records for student GPA data.

Summary of Findings

Principals' overall instructional leadership was rated at a high level, with defining the school mission as the strongest domain and managing the instructional program as the most relatively challenging. Teacher autonomous motivation was assessed at a high level, dominated by intrinsic motivation and identified regulation, with low amotivation indicating a generally engaged teaching workforce. Student academic performance, measured by Grade 10 GPA, was assessed at a satisfactory level. Significant positive relationships were found between instructional leadership and academic performance, instructional leadership and teacher motivation, and teacher motivation and academic performance. Teacher motivation partially mediated the instructional leadership-academic performance relationship, with the mediated pathway accounting for 50.7% of the total relationship, and H04 was rejected.

Conclusions

Conclusion 1. The instructional leadership of school principals in the selected Davao City public secondary schools is at a high level, reflecting the positive impact of the PPSSH framework and principal professional development programs in establishing instructional leadership as a priority behavior domain. However, the comparatively lower rating for managing the instructional program, encompassing supervisory visits and curriculum coordination, indicates that this domain remains the most challenging for principals to sustain alongside their administrative obligations.

Conclusion 2. Teacher autonomous motivation is at a high level, driven predominantly by intrinsic and values-based orientations toward teaching, reflecting the Filipino cultural valorization of the teaching profession alongside teachers' genuine professional engagement with the act of fostering student learning. The low prevalence of amotivation indicates a teaching workforce that has not experienced the disengagement that would most directly threaten instructional quality.

Conclusion 3. Student academic performance at the satisfactory level indicates that while the majority of students are meeting grade-level expectations, opportunities exist for significant performance improvement, particularly given that fewer than 10% of students are performing at the outstanding level and 23.4% are performing at the fairly satisfactory level or below.

Conclusion 4. Instructional leadership is a significant positive predictor of student academic performance, confirming that the international research literature on principal instructional leadership and student achievement is directly applicable to the Davao City public secondary school context.

Conclusion 5. Teacher motivation partially mediates the instructional leadership-academic performance relationship, establishing that approximately half of the performance benefits associated with instructional leadership operate through the motivational pathway. Principals who build teacher motivation through autonomy-supportive, professionally enriching instructional leadership generate student performance improvements that exceed what their direct instructional management activities produce alone.

Recommendations

Recommendations for School Principals. Principals are strongly recommended to prioritize the teacher motivation-enhancing dimensions of instructional leadership, specifically providing teachers with professional autonomy, recognizing instructional achievements, facilitating peer learning communities, and communicating clearly how each teacher's work contributes to the school's mission. The study finding that managing the instructional program was the most challenging domain for principals suggests that structured classroom observation programs and curriculum leadership coaching from division-level instructional supervisors should be prioritized in principal support activities.

Recommendations for the DepEd Schools Division of Davao City. The Schools Division is recommended to incorporate the empirical findings of this study into its Principal Professional Development Program, using the IMRS data to identify specific instructional leadership competencies for targeted capacity-building across participating schools. A principal coaching program pairing high-performing instructional leaders with peers demonstrating lower performance on the managing the instructional program domain would leverage the existing expertise within the division's school principal community as a professional development resource.

Recommendations for the Department of Education Central Office. The DepEd Central Office is recommended to review the administrative workload imposed on school principals with a view to reducing non-instructional compliance obligations that crowd out time available for instructional leadership activities. International evidence consistently demonstrates that reducing administrative burden on principals increases the time and energy available for instructional leadership, with measurable downstream effects on teacher professional outcomes and student achievement. A national principal time-use study would provide the empirical basis for targeted administrative burden reduction.

Recommendations for Future Researchers. Future researchers are recommended to examine the conditional nature of the instructional leadership-motivation-performance relationship, investigating whether the motivational pathway operates differently for teachers at different career stages, in schools of different sizes, or in different curriculum subject areas. Longitudinal designs tracking changes in instructional leadership quality, teacher motivation, and student performance over time would enable stronger causal inference than the cross-sectional design employed in the present study.

Final Remarks

This study demonstrates that the quality of instructional leadership exercised by school principals in Davao City public secondary schools is a significant determinant of both teacher motivation and student academic performance, with the motivational pathway accounting for over half of the leadership-performance relationship. The implications are actionable and urgent: principals who invest in the motivational conditions of their teaching staff, through autonomy-supportive supervision, meaningful professional recognition, and the clear communication of an inspiring school mission, can generate student performance improvements that transcend what individual teacher capability or curriculum quality alone can produce. The improvement of Philippine public secondary education is one of the most consequential investments the nation can make in its future. This study confirms that those investments must include, prominently and systematically, the development of instructional leaders equal to the transformative role they are called to play.

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